Designing for Facilitation in Ephemeral Social Spaces

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Background

Traditional interaction modalities





***RQ:** How does the introduction of ephemerality, voice, and embodiment complicate platform governance?*



Icon by IMG visuals icons from Noun Project

Study 1: Social VR

Novel and amplified harms and moderation challenges



METHOD

100 events observed on 3 social VR platforms (Rec Room, AltspaceVR, Horizon Worlds)

11 moderator interviews; thematic analysis

FINDINGS

45% of events involved harms

Facilitatory and proactive practices

*"the audience actually sticks to sitting in those chairs even though we're all just standing or sitting in our own chairs [...] So it's **much easier to moderate the room with chairs** because everyone's more evenly spread, you know, instead of just hugging any other surface around them" (P11)*

Study 2: Social Audio

Challenging facilitation tasks and possible technological solutions

METHOD

337 users surveyed

14 moderators and users in co-design interviews, using storyboards

16 training sessions analyzed



Example Storyboard used in interviews

FINDINGS

***"you really are the captain of your ship.** What you want in your room is what you want" (R4)*

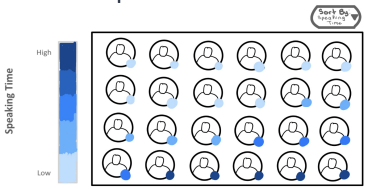
*"[the host] is simply **just not putting any kind of a control.** And they're just allowing people that are willing to, spout off [...]" (P13)*

Study 3: Highlighting Conversation Quality

Surfacing conversation quality for reflection, training spaces

METHOD

26 facilitators in co-design interviews (14 educational, 12 social audio), using design probes



FINDINGS

- Interest in metrics about engagement or those that allow for planning
- Guidance & alternatives to intervention valued, potentially due to high emotional burden